

Do animals have houses?

Many animals—from birds in trees to animals in the seas—create burrows, dens, and nests in all kinds of places. These homes are normally built as a safe place for them to live, where they can lay eggs or give birth to babies. To keep their families safe, some animals, such as beavers, build their homes in very clever ways.

Beaver builder

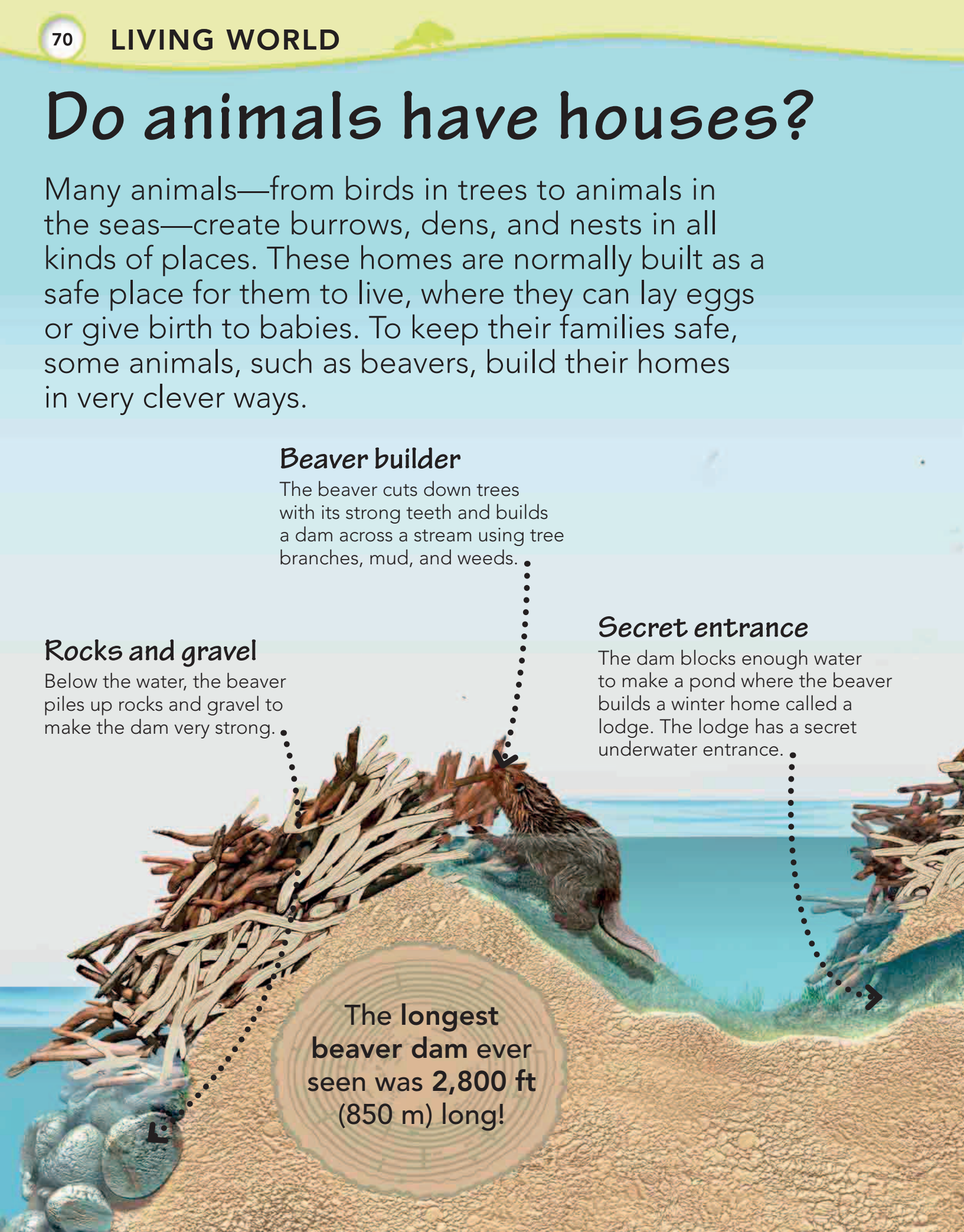
The beaver cuts down trees with its strong teeth and builds a dam across a stream using tree branches, mud, and weeds.

Rocks and gravel

Below the water, the beaver piles up rocks and gravel to make the dam very strong.

Secret entrance

The dam blocks enough water to make a pond where the beaver builds a winter home called a lodge. The lodge has a secret underwater entrance.



The longest beaver dam ever seen was 2,800 ft (850 m) long!